

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

What terrible customer service!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about common health problems.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.
- I can explain my opinion.

Ask your partner:

- How is the customer service in your country?
- Do you believe that the "customer is always right"? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

A person receives terrible **customer service***. How do they react?

* "Customer service" is the kind of behavior that service workers demonstrate towards their customers.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear readers,

I received this message from a concerned reader.

Yesterday I went to my local health clinic to make an appointment. I arrived at 9:30 a.m. The girl behind the counter was talking on the telephone. She motioned for me to sit down. There were three other people behind the counter: a young woman, an older man, and a very efficient-looking matron. The young woman was filing her nails. The old man was reading a magazine. The efficient-looking matron was staring into space. I sat down to wait. I waited for about half an hour. Obviously the clerks weren't working, and I was really annoyed.

Finally I decided to assert myself. I went up to the counter. The older man was drinking a cup of coffee. The girl was looking for something in her purse. The efficient matron was eating a sandwich. The young woman had completely disappeared. I decided to try the efficient matron.

"Excuse me," I said, "I have been waiting for half an hour. None of you are working. It seems to me that no one is available to help me."

"I'm sorry," the matron said. "Can you see that this is our break? Come back in half an hour."

I was so angry, I didn't know what to do!

Here are some reactions on my blog:

"As far as I'm concerned, you should tell on them and stand up for our rights as consumers."

"I'm convinced that customer service is going downhill these days. We need to stand up to it!"

"My personal view is that you got angry too quickly".





Let's Practice!

This is what those people at the local health clinic were doing while I was waiting to be helped.

Instructions: Select the right option for each person.

The person was really annoyed at the health clinic because:

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>1. The girl behind the counter... _____</p> <p>a. was talking on the telephone.
b. was filing her nails.
c. was not working.</p> | <p>4. The efficient-looking matron... _____</p> <p>a. was reading a magazine.
b. was staring into space.
c. wasn't working</p> |
| <p>2. The young woman... _____</p> <p>a. was talking on the telephone.
b. was filing her nails.
c. was reading a magazine.</p> | <p>5. The clerks... _____</p> <p>a. were reading magazines.
b. weren't working.
c. weren't talking.</p> |
| <p>3. The older man... _____</p> <p>a. was staring into space.
b. was reading a magazine.
c. was drinking coffee.</p> | |

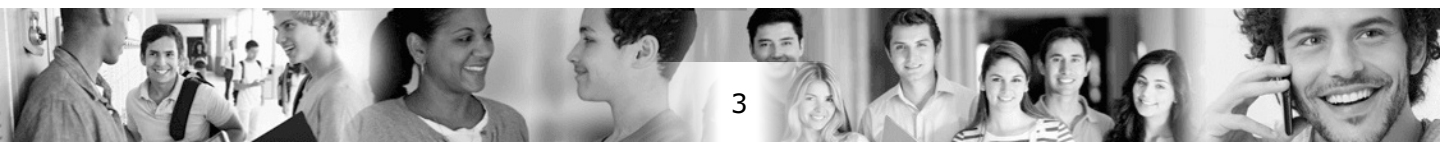


Let's Practice!

People reacted differently to what happened to the lady at the clinic.

Instructions: Underline all the correct alternatives.

- I'm convinced that / I'm fairly sure / It seems to me that no one is available to help me.
- As good as it gets / As far as I'm concerned, / It seems to me that you should tell on them and stand up for our rights as consumers.
- My personal opinion is that / As far as I'm concerned / I'm convinced that customer service is going downhill these days. We need to stand up to it!
- As far as I'm concerned / I'm convinced that / My personal opinion is that you got angry too quickly.
- It seems to me that / My personal view is that / In my opinion, the woman should have complained more politely.





Extension Activity

Write a letter of complaint about bad service.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Talk about a time that you were not happy with the service you received.
- Explain what happened and what you think about the situation.
- Write a letter of complaint to the person/people you think were responsible.
- Explain what you would like them to do to rectify the problem.
- Read your letter to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I explain what happened and express my opinion about a situation in which I received bad service.

☐ ☐

I write a letter complaining about the experience.

☐ ☐

I explain how the problem could be solved.

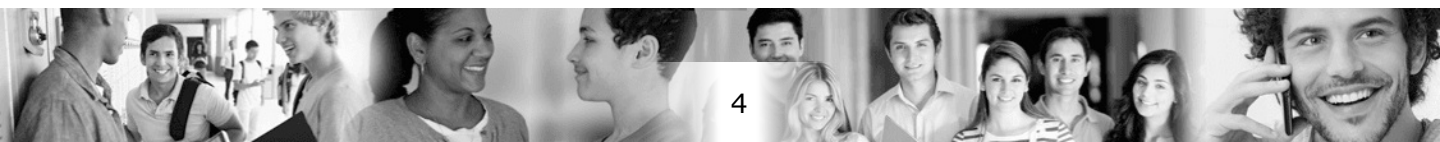
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I read my letter.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to motion** (verb): to move your hand or head in order to indicate something
e.g. She motioned for me to sit down.
- to file** (verb): to rub a metal or wooden tool against the surface of an object to make it smoother
e.g. The young woman was filing her nails.
- to stare into space** (expression): to look somewhere for a long time without actually seeing anything particular because you are thinking of something else
e.g. The efficient-looking matron was staring into space.
- to assert** (verb): to express your opinion firmly and with conviction
e.g. Finally, I decided to assert myself.
- to stand up for** (verb): to defend; especially when criticized or attacked
e.g. You should stand up for our rights as consumers.
- to stand up to** (verb): to not permit anyone to treat you badly
e.g. We need to stand up to the customer service!
- to tell on** (verb): to report to someone what somebody has done badly
e.g. You should tell on the clerks and express your concern.





Learning Points

Inseparable Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are two-part verbs consisting of a verb followed by an adverb particle (these look like prepositions, but do not have the same function in phrasal verbs).

In some cases, it is not possible to separate the verb and the particle. These are called *inseparable* phrasal verbs.

It is important to remember that the meaning of a phrasal verb is often very different from the two parts taken separately.

For example:

Matt **turned up** last night (= appeared, not the same as turned + up).

To *turn up* is an inseparable phrasal verb. You cannot put an object between the verb and the particle. It must remain together.

Another example is *to get off*.

You can say "**get off** the bus", but you cannot say "**get** the bus **off**".

A few verbs can be used with both a particle and a preposition, making them **three-part verbs**.

For example:

to run away with (to leave with; to escape with)

to watch out for (to be careful for)

to back out of (to fail to keep a promise)

Learning phrasal verbs is a lot like learning new vocabulary. You must memorize which phrasal verbs are inseparable and learn their meanings.

Look at the chart for some more inseparable phrasal verbs and their meanings.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
<i>stand up for</i>	support; defend
<i>tell on</i>	report misbehavior
<i>look for</i>	find
<i>go up to</i>	approach





Learning Points

Examples:

- *I went up to the counter.*
- *The girl was looking for something in her purse.*
- *As far as I'm concerned, you should tell on them.*
- *We need to stand up for our rights as consumers.*

The Simple Past and The Past Continuous Tenses

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous tenses together.

You can use the Past Continuous tense to refer to the context of a story. It talks about the 'background' action, or the longer action. You use it to talk about an action that was in progress in the past.

*The older man **was drinking** a cup of coffee.*

You can use the Simple Past tense to refer to a shorter action that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*Yesterday I **went** to my local health clinic to make an appointment.*

Examples:

- *The girl behind the counter was talking on the telephone.*
- *The young woman was filing her nails.*
- *The older man was reading a magazine.*
- *The efficient-looking matron was staring into space.*
- *Obviously the clerks weren't working, and I was really annoyed.*

